economic development that the companies from the imperialist 'North' do not. In its operations in the 'North', Vale works to project the image of corporate management expertise and Wall Street credentials, yet its management of the long-established nickel mines in Canada brought major turbulence. There were 11- and 18-month strikes. The labour–management relationship was stalemated by Vale's insistence on major concessions from the union as a precondition for even coming to the bargaining table. Vale's position flouted all accepted practices in Canadian traditions of collective bargaining and amounted to a frontal attack on the prevailing labour culture.

If Vale's intentions were ever in doubt, the words of Tito Martins, the then Director of Basic Metals, at the end of the 11-month strike, made them crystal clear. The major Brazilian business publication, *Valor Econômico*, published an article entitled 'Vale celebrates reducing the power of the unions in Canada'. Tito Martins claimed in the article that Vale had won everything it wanted from the prolonged arm-wrestle with its Canadian workers. Martins explained: 'What was important for Vale in this negotiation was to get the employees in Canada realigned into the same kind of relationship the company has with its employees around the world. This relationship involved three crucial issues: pension plan, bonus and chain of command between employer and employee without direct intervention of the union' (Durão 2010, my translation).

The 18-month strike in Newfoundland and Labrador, where the largely aboriginal work force is employed in a 'fly-in/fly-out' operation at Vale's Voisey's Bay mine, resulted in a call by the provincial government for a formal Industrial Inquiry (Province of Newfoundland and Labrador 2011). The main recommendation of the Inquiry was 'that government now re-examine the mechanisms by which it facilitates collective bargaining to take account of a) the organisational structure of multinational corporations, b) the need to ensure that such corporations respond to Canadian labour relations values, and c) the relative economic weight of the parties in the collective bargaining relationships (Province of Newfoundland and Labrador 2011).

Vale also has an abysmal record for health and safety since its takeover of the Canadian operations, with five fatalities since 2011, one in Thompson and four in Sudbury, plus two more fatalities in a contracted-out operation at arm's length from Vale. Three of the six fatal accidents occurred in 2014, all in Sudbury. In the words of one Vale worker in the 2012 survey, 'Whether underground or in the smelter and refinery, Vale has made it more dangerous than it was before. Removing accident, incident and concern form 079 [form encouraging any worker to make a report, even if only to register a concern], gutting training